

Esteban *Gimenez Zapiola*

CREATIVE DIRECTOR & CREATIVE AI LEAD · BCG

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I run design as a business that drives revenue,
and I built the Creative AI practice that scales it:
33 nodes, a lab of 10, 24 builders in squads.

I lead design as a commercial capability that moves revenue, and I built the Creative AI practice that scales it. As Creative Director at BCG I own the ANZ Creative Studio P&L, sit on the global leadership team, and lead the Creative AI practice across **33 nodes in the regions** and a **global lab of 10 creative technologists**, with reach into 400+ designers. I work **embedded in the case team**, hands-on alongside MDPs, BCG X engineers and the client's own technical people.

I founded the practice and authored the "*Creative Advantage*" proposal positioning it as the firm's Creative AI centre of excellence. I build agentic AI hands-on and take it to production, but the building is how I lead: I write the first working version so the direction is arguable rather than theoretical, then hand it to people who take it further.

| *Design isn't art. It's a discipline that moves revenue.*

EXPERIENCE

Nov 2024 – Present

BCG · Boston
Consulting Group

Sydney · Global

Creative Director & Creative AI Lead

- Founded and lead BCG Design Studios' **Creative AI practice**, and authored the "*Creative Advantage*" proposal positioning it as the firm's Creative AI centre of excellence.
- Lead **33 Creative AI nodes across the regions** and a **global lab of 10 creative technologists**, taking tools from proof-of-concept to working internal product. Designed the structure, defined the roles and wrote the playbook so a node runs without me.
- **Orchestrated 24 builders across squads** to ship a seven-product self-serve suite for senior partners, delivered with handover docs and briefed to named owners in other regions.
- Designed and ran the **Power Up Weeks region by region** through the regional leads, wrote and deliver the deep-dive curriculum (graph and context engineering, prompting, agent loops, building agents in Claude and GPT), and ran a **global Creative AI hackathon** end to end out of London, now a shared library of **49 skills** behind an automated review pipeline.
- **The only creative director in Design Studios running a global Creative AI programme while also delivering client work hands-on with ANZ case teams.** With MDPs, **BCG X data scientists and engineers** and the client's own technical team, I lead the coded proof-of-concept **inside the pitch rather than after it. Multiple proposals won that way** across agri-food, energy, convenience retail, beverages and banking. The win is never one person's: it is what happens when deep BCG strategy is combined with design and creative craft.
- Build and ship **agentic AI hands-on**: multi-agent systems, MCP servers, autonomous agents, a native macOS app, an AI video pipeline, and a report engine that typesets long-form publications from their source document.
- Lead the global practice across **six disciplines** and **400+ designers**, own the **ANZ Creative Studio P&L**, sit on the global Design Studios leadership team, and hold BCG's "*Grow by Growing Others*" award. Pitched, launched and executive-produce **Business and Beyond**, BCG ANZ's flagship video podcast.
- **Outcomes:** 9–13% YoY revenue growth · ~2× regional scale · ~80% cross-border delivery · double-digit conversion lifts · 33 nodes and a lab of 10 · 24 builders orchestrated.

Nov 2021 – Oct 2024

BCG · Boston
Consulting Group

Sydney

Senior Creative Manager

Head of Creative ANZ & Co-Lead, Strategy ANZ. Built the foundation for the Global role.

- Grew ANZ Creative into one of BCG's strongest regional design practices; creative strategy contributing to **9–13% YoY revenue growth** across financial services, energy, retail, public sector, healthcare and tech.
- Co-led ANZ business strategy, at the table for positioning, growth and investment decisions; partnered with MDs, Partners and C-suite to shape transformation programs. Treated design as a commercial lever, not a service.
- Began embedding AI into the creative workflow and built a mentorship-driven culture, growing senior designers into leaders and the bench that earned the Global mandate.

Jun 2018 – Nov 2021

Endeavour Group

Sydney

Creative Lead, Endeavour Drinks · *Dan Murphy's*

Creative Lead for Dan Murphy's, Australia's #1 drinks retailer; also across BWS.

- Helped grow a small in-house team into a full **in-house agency** serving the entire Endeavour portfolio, the era when digital and retail first collided.
- Built and governed the Dan Murphy's **Design System** (Frontify, InVision), the single source of truth for print, digital and coded templates.
- Led the danmurphys.com.au **restyling** ($\approx 2\times$ audience) and the **Dan Murphy's app** launch; created sub-brands incl. Dan's Run (UberEats), Direct to Boot and Dan's Cellar.
- Led and mentored a team of 6 senior designers, and was the kind of leader people wanted to work for.

Jun 2015 – Jun 2018

Endeavour Group

Sydney

Senior Digital Designer

In-house digital at agency pace, across Dan Murphy's, BWS, Langtons and Cellarmasters.

- Hand-coded EDM templates and implemented dynamic personalisation on Oracle Responsys, the foundation of Dan Murphy's segmented email program.
- Produced wireframes and restyled core components of danmurphys.com.au; led art direction and on-location shoots for tier-1 campaigns, lifting digital ROI.

Aug 2011 – Aug 2015

Kasiopea · Brand Chemistry

Buenos Aires · Sydney

Senior UX/UI Designer

Generalist principal at a Buenos Aires digital agency (pharma, energy, talent, tech): art director, UX/UI designer, front-end developer, client lead and new-business pitcher. Clients incl. Duke Energy, Engie and Farmacity. Bridged to Brand Chemistry, Sydney.

2009 – 2012

Mendioroz Design · Crested Butte

Buenos Aires · Colorado

Graphic Designer · *Ski Instructor*

Visual identity and **wayfinding** for airports and shopping centres: signage systems, technical documentation and supplier oversight, where my interest in how design lives in physical space began. Plus three winter seasons as a PSIA-certified ski instructor, coaching beginners with patience.

CAPABILITIES

- Agentic AI, hands-on** · multi-agent systems, MCP servers, autonomous agents, a native app, prototype to production.
- Building the practice, not just the tool** · 33 nodes, a lab of 10 technologists, and 24 builders across squads who shipped a seven-product suite at my direction; playbooks and handover docs so it runs without me.
- Teaching it so it sticks** · Power Up Weeks run region by region, plus the deep dives I write and deliver.
- Design leadership at scale** · high-trust teams across regions and disciplines, coaching leaders into exceptional ones, across apps, websites, design systems, brand, journeys, editorial and motion.
- Strategic partnership & commercial design** · shoulder-to-shoulder with case teams, MDPs and the C-suite; owning a studio P&L, creative as a balance-sheet asset.

HONOURS

Grow by Growing *Others*

BOSTON CONSULTING GROUP

BCG award for leaders who lift the people around them: mentorship, and growing senior talent into leaders.

Ironman World Championship (*Hawaii*)

ELITE-AMATEUR TRIATHLETE

Multiple Ironman 70.3 age-group wins; qualified for the World Championship.

EDUCATION & LANGUAGES

Mini-MBA, Business of Creativity · Future London Academy · 2025

Branding Now II · Future London Academy · 2022

Lic. Diseño de Imagen Empresaria · 2012–13 & Diseñador Gráfico · 2009–12 · Univ. de Palermo

Languages · Español (native) · English (full professional)